



Figure 1: Home page for the administrator



Figure 2: User management options



Figure 3: Creating a new user



Figure 4: Outbound and inbound mail settings

user. You will get localisation in 22 languages, unlimited API calls, free back-ups, 15 GB of storage and many other goodies. While this does seem reasonable, many of us may find the pricing on the steeper side. If you just wish to play with it, or try it before investing on it, you can even enjoy a seven-day trial at <http://goo.gl/juq4f>. Alternatively, you can download the project extensions and install your own version of the software, as mentioned below.

Installation

To run SugarCRM locally, you will need LAMP—Linux, Apache, MySQL and PHP. You can easily install the last three from your distro's repository, and information on how to install them is easily available on the Web and in previous issues of LFY. Once that's done, you can download the installation package from <http://goo.gl/nCfzi>. The installation process is self-explanatory, with an installation wizard. You simply need

to select the database type, specify user names and passwords, and off you go!

The interface

SugarCRM offers customised interfaces for each user, depending on the user's role and account attributes. Thus, the administrator gets to see the technical details that are hidden from the sales manager, while the HR manager views other information. You can, of course, tweak such abstraction to suit your needs. The interface has a header bar that has links to common tasks. It shows almost identical icons for most user accounts—*send email, create task, create note, log call, schedule meetings*, etc. Beyond that, the interface differs based on the privileges of the logged-in user. Figure 1 shows the home page for a user with admin privileges. In general, the admin interface lets you create user accounts, opportunities, documents, contacts, reports, and other similar data.

With the basics covered, let's now look at certain vital yet relatively lesser known tasks.

Importing data into SugarCRM

If you've been managing your data using any other CRM solution, or even LibreOffice Calc, SugarCRM can import the data, enabling easy continuation of your work. To import, you will need to export your data as a CSV (Comma-Separated Values) file for each module. Different software have different methods for this; in LibreOffice Calc, simply save the file as .csv. If you're using a proprietary CRM solution on the cloud, you can use the built-in *data dump* facility. Next, for each module you wish to import, go to *Shortcuts->Import* and upload the CSV file (you will need administrative privileges). SugarCRM will then give you an option to re-organise, arrange or cleanse your data of duplicates. This is it; you're done with the importing process!